WITS AHEAD RESEARCH GROUP

The AHEAD Fortnightly

Issue 3 · 29 October 2026 · Wits School of Education, University of the Witwatersrand

Dis two weeks, di biggest tori na how Africa dey push to build im own AI capability instead of just dey use wetin oda pipo build: researchers from Wits and University of the Free State both talk say di continent must set im own research and data agenda, Ghana national AI strategy get praise for readiness but pipo see say e no gum well for classroom detail, and World Bank warn say AI benefit fit pass di poorest households if light, connection and skill never dey ground first. Besides dat one, one quiet argument dey happen about trust: one Netherlands minister call AI-written thesis fraud, but universities reply say detection score no fit prove am, and one new study find out say students wey get di same grade fit don do very different amount of dia own tinkin. For us for Wits AHEAD, both tins dey point di same direction: na to build human capability to judge dis tools, no be just to dey use dem anyhow; and dis issue dey reach you for thirteen languages.

THREE THINGS TO KNOW

1

NEWS · 18 OCTOBER 2026 · KOREA, SINGAPORE AND THE UNITED KINGDOM

Universities in Korea, Singapore and the United Kingdom take different paths to redesign teaching for AI

The Korea Times report say Korean universities don add more than 4,000 slots for AI and semiconductor related courses since 2024, and say application to AI departments for twenty big universities rise by 16% dis year, as government don cap new advanced technology slots to 434 for 2027 because dem no get enough staff and facilities. Di same report compare dis expansion to Nanyang Technological University for Singapore, wey dey plan to put AI inside 40% of dia degree courses by 2030, and to King's College London and London School of Economics, wey dey redesign how dem dey assess students and dey give students and staff license to use AI tools instead of go back to hand written exams.

> **Why e matter:** For Wits AHEAD pillar wey dey focus on generative AI for higher education, dis comparison show two different way to handle di same pressure, to build more AI capacity or to redesign wetin and how dem dey assess students, one choice wey South African universities sef dey weigh for di same time.

The Korea Times · koreatimes.co.kr · Read am for source

Jung, D.-H. (2026, October 18). Korea focuses on AI majors while global universities rewrite rules of education. *The Korea Times*. koreatimes.co.kr/southkorea/education/20261018/cover-story-korea-focuses-on-ai-majors-while-global-universities-rewrite-rules-of-education

2

REPORT · 17 OCTOBER 2026 · GLOBAL

Seven-country study finds universities at very different stages of AI readiness

One study wey dem do for seven kontris by WISE and Institute of International Education find out say universities dey different stages well well for how dem ready for generative AI, as policy, student attitude and infrastructure no balance. For one private university for Ghana, 64 percent of lecturers talk say dem get clear AI policy, against 27 percent for one public research university, even though 89 percent of lecturers wey dem survey don already use AI demsef before. Di researchers warn say, because big AI models dey learn mainly from English and oda languages wey strong, African and oda Global South institutions fit remain pipo wey just dey use AI, instead of pipo wey dey build am.

> **Why e matter:** For Wits AHEAD pillar wey dey focus on responsible AI, ethics, equity and policy, di study show say di gap for readiness between institutions, no be only between kontris, fit make inequality grow pass how e dey reduce am for how higher education dey adopt AI.

WISE and the Institute of International Education (IIE), reported by University World News · universityworldnews.com · Read am for source

Abd Elgalil, T. (2026, October 17). The global AI divide: Higher education's readiness gap. *University World News*. universityworldnews.com/post.php?story=20261015140656705

3

NEWS · 15 OCTOBER 2026 · NETHERLANDS

Dutch minister calls AI-written theses 'fraud', universities say detection scores cannot prove it

One Dutch TV station check hundreds of recent master thesis for twelve universities and find out say for almost one out of five, chatbots like ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini write pass wetin di student write. Education minister, Rianne Letschert, call dis one fraud, but di body wey represent Dutch universities, Universiteiten van Nederland, talk say detection score alone no fit prove say person cheat, and say di real question na how dem design di assessment. Delft, Utrecht and Leiden don restrict or ban AI detection tools for student work, dem talk say di tools no dey reliable.

> **Why e matter:** For Wits AHEAD pillar wey dey focus on generative AI for higher education, dis matter show how academic integrity wahala fit turn political sharp sharp once minister enter, and why di group dey push for make dem redesign assessment instead of depend on detection software.

Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · Read am for source

Asaf, S. (2026, October 15). Dutch minister criticises 'fraud' as 'fifth of theses AI-written'. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/dutch-minister-criticises-fraud-fifth-theses-ai-written

RESEARCH AND REPORTS

Study proposes voice-based AI interviews as a richer alternative to end-of-semester course surveys

Technical University of Munich and the MIT Sloan School of Management, posted to arXiv · 18 October 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. For Wits AHEAD pillar wey dey focus on generative AI for higher education, dis study show one practical way to use conversational AI inside teaching: to turn weak feedback wey few people dey respond to into one wey detailed well well, wey lecturers and institutions fit use take action.

Tamme, T., Schilling, L., & Hantel, A. (2026). Voice-based AI feedback in higher education: A field study on quality and actionability. *arXiv*. doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2610.25560

Russell Group students say they are taught little about AI, Bett UK survey finds

Times Higher Education · 15 October 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. For Wits AHEAD pillar wey dey focus on generative AI for higher education, di finding say research heavy universities no teach AI skills well well like oda institutions dey raise straight equity question: which kain graduates go enter job market wey AI don change well prepared.

Luckhurst, G. (2026, October 15). Students report little AI teaching on Russell Group courses. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/students-report-little-ai-teaching-russell-group-courses

New framework guides statistics and data science educators on teaching responsible generative AI use

arXiv · 15 October 2026 · Pillar 3: STEM and teacher education. Pillar 3, AI and analytics for STEM and teacher education, need framework wey ready for classroom, no be policy statement alone; dis one give Wits AHEAD one working model to teach generative AI literacy inside number-based subject.

Davies, V., Alexander, C., Gaskell, J., Parker, M., & Lever, J. (2026). A framework for teaching the responsible and effective use of generative AI in statistics and data science. *arXiv*. doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2610.21663

FROM THE GROUP

15 Oct 2026 **The AHEAD Fortnightly, Issue 2**
You miss am? Issue 2 dey online for witsahead.org/newsletter/ for thirteen languages.

12 Sep 2026 **New PhD candidate register**
Educational leadership, curriculum reform and graduate wey no get work; proposal still dey under supervisor review.

12 Sep 2026 **Dem accept respondent and examiner for one PhD proposal presentation**
Professor Michael Bodunrin (Engineering) join di panel; cross-faculty supervision for real action.

12 Sep 2026 **Daily briefing launch for Wits AHEAD website**
News, research, video and readings wey match di group work, dem dey pick am every morning and keep am.

THINGS TO READ WEY WE RECOMMEND

Development as Freedom Amartya Sen, Oxford University Press (1999). Di H for AHEAD. Start here.

With best wishes for the fortnight ahead,

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